

World Religions 30
Assignment Booklet #4
Chapter 4: Hinduism

Name: _____

Part One: Multiple-Choice Items

Read each item carefully and decide which choice best completes the statement or answers the question. Type the letter of your choice in the blank space before the item. (20 marks).

_____	1. Hinduism is most closely associated with A. South Asia B. Scandinavia C. North Africa D. Japan only
_____	2. Brahman refers to A. ultimate divine reality B. a single temple priest C. a sacred river only D. a caste law book
_____	3. Atman refers to A. the inner self or soul B. a Hindu festival C. a place of pilgrimage only D. a temple offering tray
_____	4. Karma is best understood as A. moral cause and effect B. random luck C. a river goddess D. a caste title
_____	5. Dharma most nearly means A. duty and right order B. military power C. temple architecture D. a food law
_____	6. Moksha refers to A. release from samsara B. daily temple tax C. the worship of one statue D. a form of political rule
_____	7. Puja is A. an act of devotional worship B. a legal court C. a harvest machine D. a census record
_____	8. The Vedas are A. sacred Hindu texts B. Buddhist monasteries C. Sikh prayers D. Islamic law books
_____	9. Vishnu is often associated with A. preservation B. trade only C. river travel D. atheism
_____	10. Shiva is commonly associated with A. destruction and transformation B. census taking C. temple accounting D. farming tools
_____	11. Yoga in Hindu tradition is best understood as A. a spiritual discipline B. only physical exercise

	C. a political ideology D. a trade fair
_____	12. The Ganges is especially important as A. a sacred river B. the capital of India C. the oldest Veda D. a Hindu founder
_____	13. Diwali is often known as A. the festival of lights B. a new year tax C. a harvest drought D. a funeral rite only
_____	14. Holi is especially associated with A. colour and celebration B. strict fasting only C. pilgrimage to Mecca D. Sabbath rest
_____	15. An avatar is A. a divine manifestation on earth B. a temple drum C. a family surname D. a sacred river
_____	16. Many Hindus practice worship A. at home and in temples B. only in temples C. only outdoors D. only once a year
_____	17. Samsara refers to A. the cycle of rebirth B. one holy city C. a sacred garment D. a food offering
_____	18. A guru is generally A. a respected teacher B. a government official C. a ritual impurity D. a sacred animal
_____	19. Hinduism is best described as A. ancient and diverse B. simple and uniform C. without sacred texts D. unrelated to ethics
_____	20. A pilgrimage or holy river in Hinduism can help express A. devotion and purification B. disbelief in ritual C. separation from tradition D. rejection of family life

Part Two: Matching

Choose the letter of the term that best describes the concept or completes the sentence. Terms may be used more than once, and not all terms will be used. Enter the letter of the term into the blank space beside each statement. (15 marks).

Answer	Statement	Terms
_____	1. Ultimate divine reality in Hindu thought.	A. Brahman B. atman C. dharma D. karma E. samsara F. moksha G. Vedas H. puja I. guru J. yoga K. avatar L. Vishnu M. Shiva N. Diwali O. Ganges
_____	2. The inner self or soul.	
_____	3. Duty, moral order, and the right way to live.	
_____	4. Moral cause and effect across actions and consequences.	
_____	5. The cycle of rebirth.	
_____	6. Release from the cycle of rebirth.	
_____	7. Ancient sacred texts of Hindu tradition.	
_____	8. An act of devotional worship that may occur at home or in a temple.	
_____	9. A respected spiritual teacher.	
_____	10. A disciplined path that may unite body, mind, and spiritual practice.	
_____	11. A divine manifestation on earth.	
_____	12. A deity commonly associated with preservation.	
_____	13. A deity commonly associated with destruction and transformation.	
_____	14. A major holy day often known as the festival of lights.	
_____	15. A river regarded as sacred by many Hindus.	

Part Three: True or False

Read each statement carefully and decide if it is true or false. Type T or F in each blank beside the statement to indicate your choice for each. (15 marks).

_____	1. Hinduism can be reduced to one simple creed that all Hindus express in exactly the same way.
_____	2. Brahman can refer to ultimate divine reality.
_____	3. Atman means the inner self or soul.
_____	4. Karma teaches that actions are morally insignificant.
_____	5. Moksha is release from samsara.
_____	6. Puja is a form of devotional worship.
_____	7. The Vedas are sacred Hindu texts.
_____	8. Yoga can include spiritual discipline, not just exercise.
_____	9. The Ganges has no religious significance in Hinduism.
_____	10. Diwali is often associated with light.
_____	11. Many Hindus keep forms of worship in the home as well as at temples.
_____	12. An avatar is a kind of divine manifestation.
_____	13. Hinduism is unrelated to family and community life.
_____	14. Samsara refers to the cycle of rebirth.
_____	15. Hindu traditions have become part of Canadian religious diversity.

Part Four: Written-Response Items

Respond to the following items on the lines below the items. Attach additional pages if you need more space. (48 marks).

1. Explain why Hinduism is often described as both ancient and diverse. (4 marks)

2. Describe the relationship among Brahman, atman, samsara, and moksha. (4 marks)

3. Explain karma and dharma and how they influence moral choices. (4 marks)

4. What are the Vedas, and why are sacred texts important in Hindu tradition? (4 marks)

5. Describe the purpose of puja in home or temple worship. (4 marks)

6. Explain the importance of one Hindu deity or avatar from the chapter. (4 marks)

7. Compare the roles of family practice and temple practice in Hindu life. (4 marks)

8. Explain the significance of yoga or meditation beyond physical exercise. (4 marks)

9. Describe the importance of one festival such as Diwali or Holi. (4 marks)

10. What role can pilgrimage or a sacred river such as the Ganges play in Hindu devotion? (4 marks)

11. Explain why Hinduism cannot be reduced to one simple set of beliefs. (4 marks)

12. Describe one way Hindu traditions have become part of Canadian religious diversity. (4 marks)

Part Five: Student-Choice

Select either Option A or Option B and complete the associated tasks. Use reliable sources and attach additional pages if you need more room. (16 marks).

Option A: Hindu Deity or Symbol Study

Using reliable sources, research one Hindu deity, avatar, or symbol such as Om, a lotus, or a murti. Then respond to the following items:

1. Identify the deity, avatar, or symbol you selected. (2 marks)

2. Describe its main meaning and how it is used or understood. (4 marks)

3. Explain what beliefs or values it communicates to worshippers. (4 marks)

4. State one reason outsiders sometimes misunderstand it, and explain how you would correct that misunderstanding. (3 marks)

5. Provide a bibliography of at least two sources using proper format. (3 marks)

Option B: Hindu Festival or Temple Practice

Using reliable sources, research one Hindu festival, pilgrimage, or temple practice. Then respond to the following items:

1. Identify the festival, pilgrimage, or practice you selected. (2 marks)

2. Describe what happens during it in sufficient detail. (4 marks)

3. Explain which beliefs or values are expressed through it. (4 marks)

4. Describe one way this practice could help a Canadian student better understand Hinduism. (3 marks)

5. Provide a bibliography of at least two sources using proper format. (3 marks)

End of Assignment Booklet 4

After you have completed all items, submit your work according to your course instructions.